How to Create a Fuel / Freight Pickup Instruction

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1 Placing a Fuel / Freight Pickup Instruction

The next instruction type is the Fuel/Freight Pickup instruction and is located on the upper tab.

To add this instruction you press the Fuel/Freight Pickup button so that it is highlighted, then click on the player locomotive.

You can see that the instruction disc sits behind previously placed instructions in a row on top of the locomotive.

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2 Fuel / Freight Pickup Properties Tab

To add details to the Fuel / Freight instruction you need to open the properties by double left clicking the disc on the locomotive. The properties tab on the right hand side of the screen is initially minimised and you will probably want to pin this tab so that it is permanently visible by clicking the pin icon.

Currently all the fields are empty and the instruction list is blank.

Below is a list of each field and a description of what they mean:

Add Instruction: This adds an instruction the list in the main body of the tab. To set a Fuel / Freight instruction you first click the green plus sign then select a valid Fuel / Freight marker in the world editor. The name of the marker will then appear in the list. By default, the fuel points are named "Transfer1" etc, so you may want to rename them to something that makes more sense to the route before adding them to the list, as the name will be displayed in the scenario instructions.

To rename a fuel or freight marker, double left click the asset in the world editor and edit the properties.

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Delete Instruction: To delete an instruction from the list, firstly select the instruction you want to remove and then press the delete icon which looks like a dustbin.

Display Message: The text entered into this field is displayed as a pop-up message in-game when all instructions in the list above are completed successfully.

Achievement Text Successful: Similar to the above message, except this message is displayed if the whole scenario is completed successfully. This field does not need to be filled in unless it is on the last instruction disc of the scenario.

Achievement Text Unsuccessful: This displays a message if the instruction is not completed successfully. In the case of a Pick Up Passenger instruction, this would be if the player failed to stop at the platform and overshot.

This would not necessarily mean total failure of the entire scenario if later instructions are still completable.

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3 Editing Individual Fuel/ Freight Pickup Instructions

The separate Fuel / Freight instructions in the list show the name of the transfer point and the average expected performance %. Because the location of the fuel / freight point is not displayed, it would be friendlier to name it in the world editor to something containing information about the location; such as Bath Coal Tower. This should be done before that transfer point is used in an instruction. If a transfer point is in the instruction list and is then subsequently deleted or renamed, then a question mark will appear after the name indicating that it cannot be found.

Handle Off Path: The dispatcher automatically calculates the best path for the train based on all the values contained in the scenario. Deviating from this path results in an error. This could end up failing the scenario.

There will be times, however, when it should be correct for the player to leave this pre-calculated path. An example would be in yard activities, where the player should be free to use any path through the yard as long as the instruction gets completed.

Leaving the box unchecked means the path does not have to be adhered to, and no error will be given for leaving the path until this instruction is completed.

Checking the box means the path in enforced and the player must stick to it for this instruction.

% Performance: The average expected performance is set to 75% by default. Adjusting this value higher will create a stricter timetable and changing the value lower will create a more relaxed timetable. If this value is edited the anticipated arrival and departure times on this and all subsequent instructions will be updated.

Editing this value is a good way to control the speeds of AI traffic on the route.

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4 Setting Coal / Water / Diesel Levels

You can display the fuel levels of a diesel locomotive by double clicking the locomotive itself. In the case of a steam train, you must double click the tender. Electric trains have no such properties. Examples of the fuel level properties tab are shown below:

There is a sliding bar which can be adjusted from left to right to set the start fuel level percentage for the locomotive in the scenario. If your scenario involves refuelling or filling with water, then these levels should be taken down from the maximum.

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5 Setting Wagon Load State

In a similar way, by double clicking each freight wagon you can display its properties window and set whether its initial state is loaded or unloaded. You cannot load freight, such as coal, onto an already loaded wagon and conversely you cannot unload freight from an empty wagon.

In the picture above, the wagon has the "Pre-Load Cargo" box unchecked, which is the default. Checking the box fills the wagon with suitable fright (coal, container etc), and it can then be unloaded.

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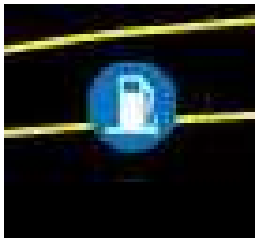
6 Viewing the Instructions

In Drive mode you can check the Assignment Assistant and see the instructions as the end user would when playing the scenario.

How the instruction is worded is based on the type of transfer point that was selected:

- For a freight container crane the instruction displays as "Pick up a Freight Container from <transfer point name>
- For fuel (coal / diesel / water) the instruction displays as "Pick up Fuel <fuel type> from <transfer point name>"; for example, "Pick up Fuel (Coal) from Bath Coaling Stage"

On the 2D map, water transfer points display as a water droplet whereas diesel and freight transfer points display as a fuel pump.



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